CHESS SIMPLIFIED!

"CHESS-DRAUGHTS"

A NEW FAMILY GAME COMBINING THE PRINCIPLES OF

CHESS WITH THE EASINESS OF DRAUGHTS,

BY

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THE reflections on the facts which have caused me to try the invention of a game such as I have succeeded in laying before the public, differ from the causes of many other inventions, at all events, in the one respect, that they will doubtlessly meet with the approval of the great majority of competent judges, in this instance of everyone who cares to foster family games. Those reflections consist in the following arguments :—

1. The game of Chess, which occupies the first rank amongst all family games, does not only require a superior mental intellect of the player, but also a continuous practice, in order to be played well and correctly. Supposing this practice has been discontinued for some time, a renewed mental study of figurations with which the player used to be quite familiar, cannot be dispensed with; and this is sufficiently tiresome for a good many people as "to do without it." This is the history of the innumerable amount of Chess heroes "who used to play very well indeed," but who obstinately refuse to prove their talent, even in response to a challenge of only a moderate player.

   From the want, therefore, to possess an easier family game which could be played with less mental exertions and less continuity of practice,—

2. *The game of Draughts* has resulted, and the fact is known enough that this game has secured itself a place in nearly every family of all civilised nations. But if there was a relaxation as to Chess from the necessity of too great a practice, the reverse thing happened as to Draughts, the dull repetition of the same moves over and over again not admitting of too great a practice without becoming overdone.

DRAUGHTS ARE WORN OUT!

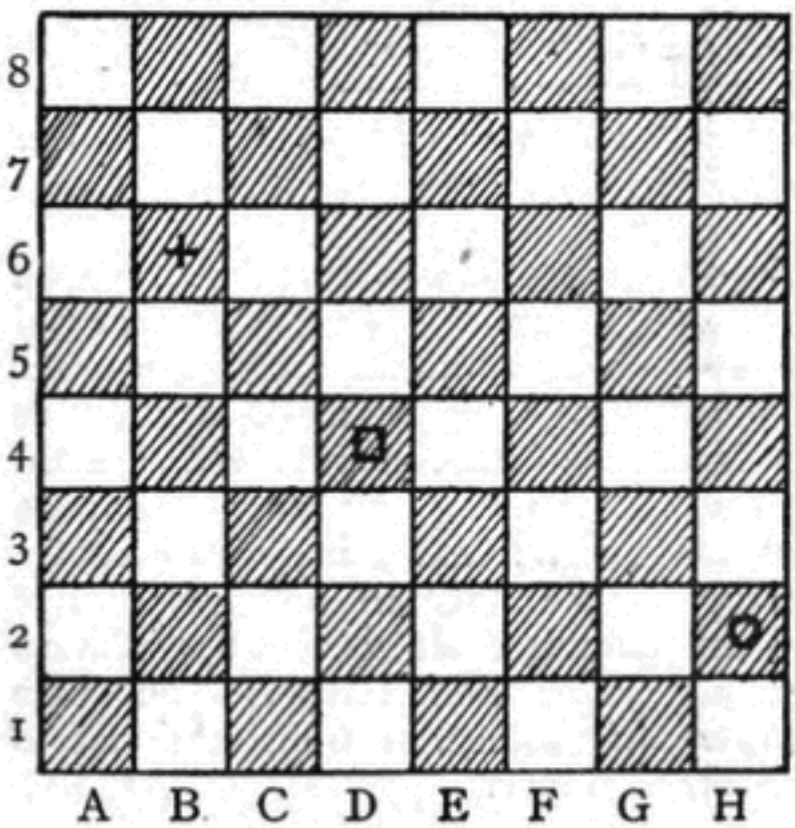
It cannot be disputed, therefore, that a new game combining a greater capability of combination and a more interesting figuration with the advantage not to require any greater exertions than Draughts, will be sure to be the means of enjoying many a pleasant hour for young and old. To arrive at this aim, is the task of my newly invented

"CHESS-DRAUGHTS,"

and he who will take the trouble of thinking himself into the spirit of the following description with the board and the figures before him, may judge for himself whether I have completed my task on not. I have no doubt that the general opinion will be in my favour.

THE GAME.

A USUAL draughts or chess board with 64 squares is put in the usual way, viz., that the white corner is at your right hand side. In order to explain the moves, and to enable the player to follow them, we will number the squares all in the usual fashion. Many boards are already numbered, but where this is not the case, a strip of paper can easily be affixed and furnished with figures after the following style :—



So the name of the square + would be B6, of □ D4, and of ○ H2, etc.

The men of the one party are mostly WHITE, those of the other party are BLACK. The white men are always put on that side of the board which commences by row 1, and the black men are placed opposite. The white men have the first move; and, on commencing to play, it is subject to chance as to who is to play with them. In the succeeding games the loser moves first. Should, on commencing, the white men fall to the party who is sitting before the black ones, the whole board would be turned, and not the men alone. This rule, however, need not be regarded, when no reference is being made to the names of the squares by means of figures and letters, *i.e.*, at free play.

It is not absolutely necessary to have men specially adapted to Chess Draughts, although, this adds considerably to the beauty of the game.* They may be replaced by ordinary men at chess, or also at draughts, when the following rules will be observed :—

1. *The Knight* may be replaced by the Queen at Chess or by two men at Draughts.

2. *The Lady* by the King at Chess, or by three men at Draughts.

3. *Six Pawns*, or men, by the ordinary chess pawns, or men at draughts.

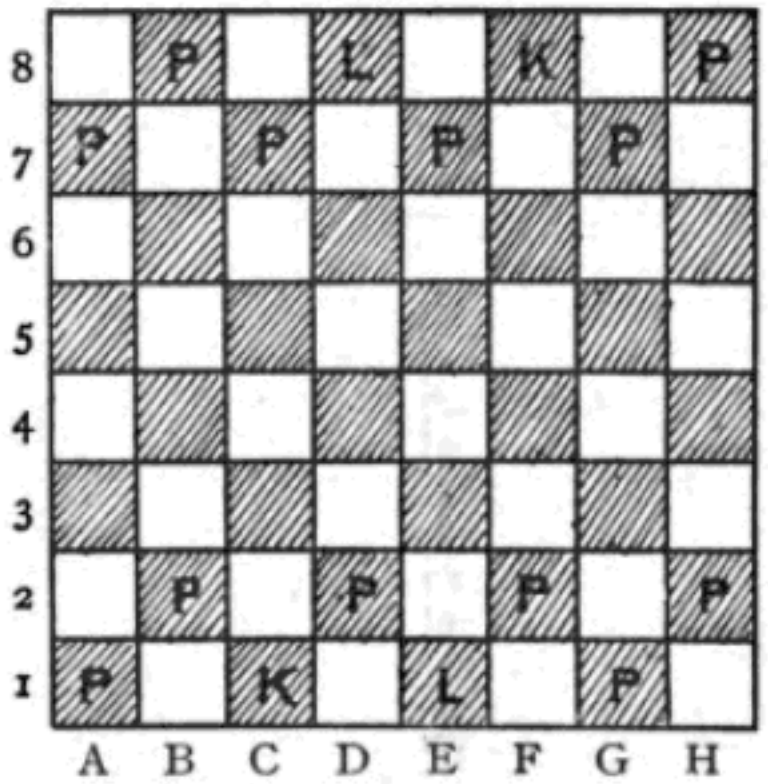
* If your stationer should not sell them apply to Mr. JOHN LEON, 29, De Beauvoir Square, London, N.

The order of battle is arrayed in the following manner :—

1. White: Knight (= K) C1.
   Lady (= L) E1.
   Pawns (= P) A1, G1, B2, D2, F2, H2.
2. Black: K = F8.
   L = D8.
   P = B8, H8, A7, C7, E7, G7.

The board ready for playing looks accordingly :

BLACK.



WHITE.

THE RULES OF THE GAME

are few and simple.

1. The Men play on the black squares only.
2. The Pawns always go one square forward, never backwards.
3. The Lady draws in both directions, but one square only at a time.
4. The Knight draws any distance in both directions, as long as the line is free : so the value of the Knight is the same as that of the Bishop at chess, and the value of a Lady the same as that of a Crowned Man at draughts.
5. The Men of the enemy *can* be taken by the other party as soon as they come within their reach, but they need not make use of this right. The player must be guided by the advantage which he believes to obtain by doing so, but a Man should not be exchanged for a Man, nor a Knight for a Knight, unless a visible advantage should result from the position thus created. Still, what practice the player might choose, is entirely left with his discretion. I, for my part, do not like useless blood-shedding.
6. The Man which takes is placed on the square he takes from, the same as chess, but different from draughts.
7. If a Pawn should succeed in advancing into the first row of the enemy's position, he will be Knighted, *i.e.*, he will be exchanged for a second, third or fourth Knight, as the case may be, the number of admissible Knights being unlimited. When playing

with Men at chess, the Pawn may be exchanged for any Officer, and when playing with Men at draughts, a second Man will crown him.

8. The game is lost when the Lady is caught.

. . . . . .

The last point concerning the rule, when the game is lost, seems to involve a strange deviation from the rules of chess, according to which the loss of the *King* is identical with the loss of the game, whereas the Lady (the Queen) is to play that rôle which I have transferred upon the Knight. Practically, there is no difference in this, but, from an ethic point of view, I do consider the arrangement of Chess Draughts superior to that of Chess in this respect, because I do not deem it compatible with the dignity of a "Lady," to entangle with any kind of doubtful positions, always to contend for the first and final word, and at every opportunity she may espy to take the enemy by his hair. Such duty is incumbent upon the Knight who audaciously throws himself into any danger to proctect his Lady from the hostile attacks. On the other hand, the unwieldiness of the King at Chess does not show a manly character at all, and is much rather suited to the bashful reservedness of the "Lady," who would not, when attacked, defend herself by her physical strength, but seek protection with her Knight or with her subjects. Only in the extremity, when, at close fight, a daring fellow should stretch out his arm to seize the Lady, which the Knight might be unable to help, then only she has, by the right of moving one step, the means of self-defence in her hand and to punish her offender by giving him the death blow.

But, when she sees her troops die away before the hostile power, when even her Knight has fallen, then she would rake up together all her power, be it ever so little, to advance step for step, but with the courage of despair, against the enemy, and, amidst the rest of her warriors, by a last grand trick either to do or to die.

That is the display of the picture which arises before our eyes in a thousand variations by playing at Chess Draughts, and everyone who has but slightly acquainted himself with the features of the game, will, with pleasure, exchange the usual "Draughts" for the new ones.

Although the instructions I have given are quite sufficient to play the game correctly, I will play two games with you now, and also commence two others, the solution of which I must leave to yourself. Follow each move attentively on the board and study the position.

I. White	Black.
1. D2 — C3	1. E7 — F6
2. B2 — A3	A3 cannot be taken by K F1 owing to protection by K C1.
	2. K F8 — D6
3. A3 — B4	3. C7 — B6
4. K C1 — A3	4. B6 — A5

This move apparently serves the purpose to seduce B4 to take A5 in which case K A3 could be taken off by K D6. White cleverly escapes the trap by—

5. B4 — C5	5. K D6 — E5
6. A1 — B2	6. B8 — C7

This move is indispensably necessary, as otherwise C5 protected by K A3 would attack the Lady D8 and subsequently be Knighted.

7. F2 — E3	7. F6 — G5
	To give room to the Knight E5 if attacked by :—
8. C3 — D4	8. K E5 — F6.
9. C5 — D6	9. C7 — D6
10. K A3 — D6	10. A7 — B6
11. B2 — C3	11. G5 — H4
12. E3 — F4	12. G7 — H6
13. D4 — E5	13. K F6 — G7
14. G1 — F2	14. H6 — G5
15. F4 — G5	15. B6 — C5

White stupidly jumps into this move by—

16. K D6 — C5	16. K G7 — E5

After having made one mistake people are most likely to let another one follow. In order not to lose H2, White moves :—

17. H2 — G3	17. K E5 — C3

And the White Lady is lost.

II. White	Black.
1. B2 — A3	1. E7 — D6
2. D2 — C3	2. K F8 — E7
3. K C1 — B2	3. A7 — B6
4. C3 — D4	4. D6 — C5
5. D4 — E5	5. C7 — D6
6. F2 — E3	6. K E7 — H4
7. G1 — F2	7. B8 — C7
8. E3 — F4	8. B6 — A5
9. F2 — G3	9. K H4 — E7
10. B2 — C3	10. C7 — B6
11. E5 — D6	11. K E7 — D6
12. F4 — E5	12. K D6 — C7
13. E5 — F6	13. G7 — H6
14. K C3 — D2	14. K C7 — D6
15. D2 — H6	15. C5 — B4
16. K H6 — E3	16. B6 — C5
17. K A3 — G5	

Black supposes correctly that White intends to move F6 — G7, thereby forcing the Lady to move and subsequently taking H8 to get Knighted.

	17. K D6 — E5
18. F6 — E7	18. L D8 — C7
19. E7 — D8 (K)	19. L C7 — B8
20. G3 — F4	20. K E5 — C3
21. L E1 — F2	21. B4 — A3
22. K D8 — B6	22. A5 — B4
23. K G5 — D8	23. K C3 — D4
24. L F2 — G3	24. K D4 — E5
25. F4 — E5	25. A3 — B2
26. K D8 — C7	Black is the loser.

III. White	Black
1. D2 — E3	1. C7 — D6
2. K C1 — D2	2. A7 — B6
3. E3 — D4	3. B8 — A7
4. D2 — E3	4. G7 — F6
5. B2 — C3	5. D6 — C5
6. D4 — C5	6. E7 — D6
7. C3 — B4	7. F6 — E5
8. C5 — B6	8. A7 — B6
9. K E3 — B6	9. L D8 — E7
10. B4 — C5	10. D6 — C5
11. K B6 — C5	11. L E7 — D8
12. K C5 — F8	Etc.
	Black will lose.

IV.

1. B2 — A3	1. A7 — B6
2. K C1 — B2	2. E7 — F6
3. F2 — E3	3. K F8 — D6
4. E3 — D4	4. B8 — A7
5. K B2 — C3	5. G7 — H6
6. D2 — E3	6. H6 — G5
7. A3 — B4	7. G5 — H4
8. L E1 — F2	8. F6 — G5
9. D4 — C5	Observe the danger, if K C3 would move to F6; besides the K D6 is attacked.
	9. K D6 — E7
10. K C3 — D4.	

It is no use taking H8 by K C3, White being too weak on square C5. The K C3 therefore protects C5 and the next moves will probably be for the Black that C7 induces D6 to exchange, so that the Black K may govern the line B8 — H2 to eventually attack the Lady, and for White to move on with A1, and as soon as possible to take H8 off. At present the position is in favor of White, and here I will leave it to the Black how to get out of it.

. . . . . .

After having shown the principles of Chess Draughts by both its proper moves and the mistakes which are liable to be incurred, I may now safely leave the proper management of the game to the beginner himself, who has kindly followed the development of the combinations. After a few games he will be in the position to discover the plentitude of figurations hidden behind the few men of the board, and which will afford him such an interest and pleasure as to do thoroughly away with the old. dull and worn-out Draughts in favor of

"CHESS-DRAUGHTS."